

Class 9 English - Kaveri

Chapter 3: Winds of Change

Detailed, Exam-Oriented Solutions

Chapter	Winds of Change
Genre	Informative / Expository prose
Subject	Traditional Indian pankhas (hand fans), their regional diversity, cultural value and changing role
Key idea	Traditional crafts can survive when cultural appreciation, innovation, awareness and sustainable livelihoods work together.

1. Chapter Information

The chapter explores the history and cultural significance of the pankha—the traditional hand fan. It begins with the word's connection to pankh, meaning a bird's feather, and traces the fan from ancient India to the present.

The text explains that different regions developed distinctive fans using local materials and techniques. Rajasthan is known for appliqué, zardozi and temple fans; Gujarat for mirror-work, bead and leather fans; Bengal for sola fans; Uttar Pradesh for Phadh fans; and Bihar for colourful bamboo fans.

Modern technology has reduced the everyday need for hand fans, creating a risk that the craft may lose cultural visibility. At the same time, the craft has become a commercial product and a source of livelihood for artisans. The chapter therefore advocates celebration, exhibitions, workshops, awareness and thoughtful innovation as ways to keep the tradition alive.

2. Important Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
indigenous	local; originating in a particular place
innovative	new and original in approach
industrious	hardworking
intricate	elaborate and detailed
invoked	brought out or called forth
initiative	an action taken to improve a situation
exotic	unusual and attractive because of foreign or unfamiliar qualities
antiquity	the distant past
advent	arrival or beginning of something
perpetually	constantly
encrusted	covered or decorated with something
ornate	highly decorated
aesthetically pleasing	beautiful or attractive in appearance
sustainable livelihood	a way of earning that can continue over time
commercial	related to buying and selling

3. Reading for Meaning - Complete Solutions

Q. What does the word 'pankha' originate from?

Answer: It originates from the word pankh, meaning the feather of a bird.

Q. What is a 'pankhi'?

Answer: A pankhi is a small plumed fan used in ancient India.

Q. Where can evidence of pankhi be found?

Answer: Evidence can be seen in Buddhist wall paintings at Ajanta dating back to the second century CE.

Q. How were pankhas used in ancient India?

Answer: They were used in temples to fan deities and in royal courts to fan kings. Their sizes ranged from very small fans to large fans requiring considerable arm strength to move.

Q. Why did different regions develop different varieties of pankhas?

Answer: Local geography, available materials, cultural practices and traditional rituals influenced the design and construction of pankhas. As a result, different regions developed distinctive shapes, materials and decorative techniques.

Q. What materials have traditionally been used to make pankhas?

Answer: Materials include bamboo, cane, palm leaf, silk, brass, leather and silver. Decorative beads, stones, embroidery, mirror work and metalwork are also used.

Q. How have pankhas changed in modern times?

Answer: Their practical use has declined because of modern cooling technologies, and they are now largely used as decorative or traditional craft objects. At the same time, they have developed into commercial handicraft products that provide livelihood opportunities for artisans.

Q. Why is the pankha described as a culture rather than merely an object?

Answer: Because its materials, designs, techniques and uses are connected with regional history, community traditions, rituals, craftsmanship and identity. The fan therefore carries cultural knowledge as well as practical value.

4. Check Your Understanding - Pankha Table

State/Region	Type	Material / Feature
Rajasthan	Appliqué hand fan	Pieces of fabric sewn onto cloth with ornamental needlework
Rajasthan	Zardozi hand fan	Gold threadwork
Rajasthan	Temple hand fan	Engraved brass with a long handle
Gujarat	Mirror-work hand fan	Pure cotton with mirror work
Gujarat	Beads hand fan	Colourful beads and a silver handle
Gujarat / Kutch	Leather hand fan	Leather decorated with thread and wool
West Bengal	Sola hand fan	Milky-white spongy centre of sola
Uttar Pradesh	Phadh hand fan	Gold, silver zari, silk and satin frills
Bihar	Bamboo hand fan	Bamboo

5. Critical Reflection - Extract 1

Q. Pankhas were one of the most popular items of commerce. True or false?

Answer: False. The extract says they became significant cultural goods distributed through trade routes, but it does not state that they were one of the most popular commercial items.

Q. Why has the word 'traditional' been used to describe pankhas?

Answer: Because the craft has been passed down through generations and is associated with long-established regional materials, designs, techniques and cultural practices.

Q. Why is 'They were considered exotic and stylish' an opinion rather than a fact?

Answer: The statement expresses an evaluation of how the fans were regarded. Words such as 'exotic' and 'stylish' involve judgement or perception rather than a measurable fact.

Q. Infer one reason for the commonality in the use of pankhas across India.

Answer: The basic purpose of a hand fan—to create airflow and provide relief from heat—is common across regions. This practical need explains the widespread use of pankhas.

Q. Reason: Pankhas were made of indigenous materials, unique to the region, with elaborate designs. Which assertion is correct?

Answer: A. Each kind of pankha could be distinguished from the other. The regional materials and designs made the varieties distinctive.

6. Critical Reflection - Extract 2

Q. Infer one negative impact of technological advancement on pankhas.

Answer: Modern cooling technologies have reduced the practical need for hand fans, which may cause traditional pankha-making to lose visibility and cultural presence.

Q. Why does the writer refer to pankhas as a 'culture' rather than only an object?

Answer: Because pankhas embody regional craftsmanship, materials, designs, history, rituals and community traditions. They represent cultural knowledge and identity.

Q. Which line shows how the role of the pankha has changed?

Answer: "Once made for personal use, over time this handicraft has transformed into a commercial business and now provides some form of livelihood to India's artisans."

Q. How might increased demand benefit artisans?

Answer: It can create more sales, income and employment, encourage artisans to continue the craft and make the traditional skill economically sustainable.

Q. Which factor has contributed to the commercialisation of pankhas?

Answer: B. Economic demand. Growing demand for different versions has helped turn the handicraft into a commercial activity.

7. Textbook Critical Reflection - Long Answers

Q. How does the title 'Winds of Change' capture the essence of the chapter?

Answer: The title operates at two levels. Literally, a fan creates a movement of air or 'wind'. At a deeper level, the chapter describes changes in the status and use of traditional pankhas. They have moved from practical everyday objects to decorative and commercial handicrafts. Technology has reduced their everyday use, while innovation, exhibitions and new markets offer opportunities for revival. Thus, the title captures both the physical function of the fan and the social and cultural changes surrounding it.

Q. Support the statement: 'The structure and design of pankhas are testimony to the cultural identity of the region.'

Answer: Regional pankhas reflect local materials and artistic traditions. Rajasthan's appliqué, zardozi and engraved brass fans show its textile and metalwork traditions. Gujarat's mirror, bead and leather fans reflect its distinctive handicraft practices. Similarly, Bengal's sola fans and Bihar's bamboo fans use locally associated materials. These differences make each regional fan a visible expression of cultural identity.

Q. How can traditional craftsmanship be preserved while incorporating innovative designs?

Answer: Preservation should retain the essential traditional techniques, materials and cultural identity while allowing artisans to experiment with contemporary shapes, colours, uses and markets. Modern designs can make pankhas attractive to new customers without erasing the traditional methods that make them culturally valuable. Workshops and exhibitions can teach the traditional process while encouraging responsible innovation.

Q. How might pankha-making workshops contribute to preservation?

Answer: Workshops create opportunities for people to learn about the craft directly from artisans. They increase awareness among younger generations, demonstrate the skill involved, encourage appreciation and may create new customers. If linked with exhibitions or markets, they can also help artisans earn sustainable incomes.

Q. How can celebrating pankhas benefit artisans and the craft?

Answer: Celebration increases public awareness and appreciation. Exhibitions and cultural events provide artisans with platforms to demonstrate and sell their work. Greater visibility can increase demand, strengthen livelihoods and encourage younger people to learn the craft, helping preserve it for future generations.

Q. How does restricting pankhas mainly to decorative purposes reflect their changing cultural role?

Answer: Earlier, pankhas served an important practical purpose in cooling people. Modern technology has reduced that need, so their everyday functional role has declined. Their continued presence as decorative objects, however, shows that they retain cultural and artistic value. The shift therefore represents adaptation rather than complete disappearance.

8. Vocabulary and Structures in Context

Fixed expressions with 'and'

Expression	Meaning
hard and dry	in a difficult situation, without help or money
wear and tear	damage to an object due to normal use
facts and figures	accurate and detailed information
all and sundry	everyone, not just a few special people
time and again	often; on many or all occasions
cut and run	to make a quick or sudden escape
thick and thin	even when there are problems or difficulties

Q. Classify the pairs 'exotic and stylish', 'villages and towns', 'thread and wool', 'silk and brass', 'ornate and encrusted', 'within and outside'.

Answer: Appearance: exotic and stylish; ornate and encrusted. Place: villages and towns; within and outside. Material: thread and wool; silk and brass.

Q. Choose the correct collocation: The students have to (take/give) the English exam tomorrow.

Answer: take the English exam.

Q. The interviewer asked the candidate to (take/have) a seat.

Answer: take a seat.

Q. My scooter (dashed against/ran into) a car.

Answer: ran into a car.

Q. I must (take/own) responsibility for my success.

Answer: take responsibility for my success.

Q. I would like to (tone up/improve) my grammar.

Answer: improve my grammar.

9. Present Perfect Tense - Complete Solution

The present perfect is formed with has/have + past participle. It describes a past action that has a present connection or relevance.

Completed paragraph: Puppets have long fascinated audiences worldwide. Puppeteers have created intricate characters and captivating stories with their skillful artistry. They have mastered the delicate movements that bring these lifeless figures to life. Over the years, puppetry has evolved, using modern technology while preserving traditional techniques. Many puppeteers have passed down their craft through generations, ensuring its continuity. They have performed in theatres, on television, and at festivals, conveying important cultural narratives.

10. Listening Activity - Answer Key

The correct statements are 2, 3, 4 and 6.

2: Priya suggests a pankha that can be easily moved around. 3: Rohan says Grandma enjoys sitting in the verandah during evenings. 4: Priya knows Grandma likes to keep special items close to her. 6: Priya suggests choosing between a bamboo pankha with beadwork and an embroidered pankha with mirror work.

11. Writing Task - Model Answer

A Traditional Artefact: The Hand Fan

The hand fan I have learnt about is a traditional Indian craft item. It is generally light and portable and may be made from bamboo, palm leaf, cloth, leather or other locally available materials. Depending on the region, it may be decorated with embroidery, mirrors, beads, zari or painted designs.

Traditionally, the hand fan was used to create airflow during hot weather. Different communities developed their own styles according to available materials and artistic traditions. Today, many traditional fans are used mainly as decorative objects or sold as handicrafts. Their continued production supports artisans and preserves regional craftsmanship.

12. Learning Beyond the Text – Model Project

Example: Chikankari as a Regional Craft of Uttar Pradesh

Chikankari is a traditional embroidery craft associated especially with Lucknow. It uses delicate threadwork to create floral and geometric patterns on fabric. The craft is valued for its fine handwork, elegance and detailed designs. Traditionally it has been used on garments and household textiles. Modern designers have introduced Chikankari into contemporary clothing while retaining many traditional motifs. Similar to the pankha, its preservation depends on skilled artisans, public appreciation, fair markets and opportunities for younger generations to learn the craft.

Suggested presentation: name of craft → region → materials → making process → traditional use → present-day use → cultural importance → challenges → preservation measures.

13. Very Short Answer Questions

Q. What does 'pankh' mean?

Answer: Feather of a bird.

Q. What is a pankhi?

Answer: A small plumed fan used in ancient India.

Q. Where are ancient depictions of pankhi found?

Answer: At Ajanta Buddhist wall paintings.

Q. Name two materials used for pankhas.

Answer: Bamboo and palm leaf.

Q. Which state is associated with Phadh hand fans?

Answer: Uttar Pradesh.

Q. Which state is known for sola hand fans?

Answer: West Bengal.

Q. What material is strongly associated with Bihar's hand fans?

Answer: Bamboo.

Q. What does 'advent' mean?

Answer: Arrival or beginning.

Q. What is a sustainable livelihood?

Answer: A way of earning that can continue over time.

Q. Why are workshops useful?

Answer: They spread awareness, teach the craft and can support artisans.

14. Additional Exam-Oriented Questions

Q. Why did pankhas develop distinctive regional forms?

Answer: Regional availability of materials, local craftsmanship, culture, geography and rituals shaped their different designs.

Q. How does handicraft support cultural identity?

Answer: It preserves traditional techniques, motifs, materials and stories associated with particular communities and regions.

Q. What is the double effect of technology on traditional crafts?

Answer: Technology can reduce demand for traditional practical objects, but it can also provide new design possibilities, markets and ways of promoting crafts.

Q. Why is commercialisation not necessarily harmful to traditional crafts?

Answer: If managed responsibly, commercialisation can provide artisans with income and motivate continued production while preserving cultural authenticity.

Q. Why are artisans important to the preservation of pankha culture?

Answer: They possess the practical knowledge and craftsmanship required to make the fans; without skilled makers the tradition cannot survive as a living craft.

15. MCQs

N o.	Question	Ans.
1	The word 'pankha' is derived from: A. pankh B. pankhi C. pankti D. pavan	A
2	Pankh means: A. wind B. feather C. cloth D. leaf	B
3	Evidence of pankhi is found in: A. Ajanta paintings B. Red Fort C. Konark temple only D. Harappan seals	A
4	Which is a material used in traditional pankhas? A. Bamboo B. Plastic only C. Concrete D. Steel only	A
5	The structure of a regional fan reflects its: A. cultural core B. weather report C. political system D. school curriculum	A
6	Gujarat is associated with: A. mirror and bead hand fans B. only paper fans C. only wooden fans D. none	A
7	Bengal's delicate pankhas may be made from: A. sola B. iron C. marble D. cement	A
8	Uttar Pradesh's Phadh fans are decorated with: A. gold, silver zari, silk and satin frills B. only bamboo C. only leather D. wool only	A
9	Bihar is recognised in the chapter for: A. bamboo hand fans B. zardozi fans only C. sola fans D. brass fans only	A
10	Modern pankhas are mainly used as: A. decorative craft items B. weapons C. toys only D. machines	A
11	One risk posed by technological advancement is: A. reduced practical use of traditional fans B. more clay C. more rainfall D. loss of electricity	A
12	A sustainable livelihood means: A. income that can continue over time B. a temporary hobby C. unpaid work only D. seasonal tourism only	A
13	A workshop can help a craft by: A. spreading awareness and teaching skills B. stopping artisans C. removing designs D. banning sales	A
14	The title 'Winds of Change' refers to: A. both the fan's movement of air and changing status of the craft B. weather only C. storms only D. travel	A
15	Which is an example of ornate decoration? A. elaborate zardozi work B. plain paper C. bare bamboo only D. no design	A

16. Exam Answer-Writing Tips

- Quote or refer to a specific regional example whenever possible.
- In analytical answers, connect craft → culture → livelihood → preservation.
- For competency questions, distinguish the benefits of technology from its possible negative effect on traditional practices.
- Remember the key regional examples: Rajasthan, Gujarat, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.